

Project Design Phase
Problem – Solution Fit Template

Date	15 February 2025
Project Name	Network Request Approval Automation
Maximum Marks	2 Marks

Problem – Solution Fit Template:

The Problem–Solution Fit ensures that the developed Network Request Approval Automation System addresses the real challenges faced by employees and IT administrators. By automating request submission, approval routing, and notification processes in ServiceNow, the solution reduces manual work, speeds up approvals, and improves service efficiency.

Purpose:

Solve the Problem

- Automate the network request approval process and eliminate manual approvals.

Improve Efficiency

- Reduce approval delays by routing requests automatically to the assigned manager.

Enhance Communication

- Keep employees informed through automated email notifications at every stage.

Increase Productivity

- Minimize repetitive administrative tasks and reduce human errors.

Improve User Experience

- Provide a simple Service Catalog form for submitting network requests and tracking approval status.

Build Trust

- Ensure every request follows a transparent approval workflow with proper audit records.

Understand Existing Process

- Replace slow, paper-based or email-based approval methods with an automated ServiceNow workflow.

Template:

Define CS, refine CC	1. CUSTOMER SEGMENT(S) CS Who is your customer? Employees / Users who need network services in the organization. - IT Users / Employees - IT Managers / Approvers - Network Engineers - IT Administrators	6. CUSTOMER CONSTRAINTS CC What constraints prevent your customers from taking action or limit their choices of solutions? - Manual request process takes too much time - Approval delays due to email/phone based process - Lack of visibility on request status - No centralized tracking of network requests - High dependency on IT team for follow-ups - Risk of requests being missed or lost	5. AVAILABLE SOLUTIONS AS Which solutions are available to the customers when they face the problem or need to get the job done? What have they tried in the past? What pros & cons do these solutions have? - Email-based requests – Slow, untracked - Phone calls / Walk-ins – Unorganized - Excel/Shared sheets – Manual, error-prone - Third-party tools – Costly, complex - Paper forms – Delay in approvals (Our solution automates the entire process in ServiceNow)	Explore AS, differentiate
	2. JOBS-TO-BE-DONE / PROBLEMS J&P Which jobs-to-be-done (or problems) do you address for your customers? There could be more than one; explore different sides. - Submit a network request quickly - Get manager approval without delay - Track request status in real time - Receive notifications on approval/rejection - Maintain proper records and history - Reduce manual work and follow-ups	9. PROBLEM ROOT CAUSE RC What is the real reason that this problem exists? What is the back story behind the need to do this job? - Manual & email-based process with no automation - No central platform for request submission & approval - Lack of visibility and tracking - Multiple handovers cause delays - No automated notifications - No proper audit trail and reporting	7. BEHAVIOUR BE What does your customer do to address the problem and get the job done? i.e. directly related: find the right solar panel installer, calculate usage and benefits; indirectly associated: customers spend free time on volunteering work. - Users send requests via email or phone - Managers approve through email replies - IT team manually updates status - Users follow up for status updates - Time is spent in repeated communication - Data maintained in spreadsheets or notes	
3. TRIGGERS TR What triggers customers to act? i.e. seeing their neighbour installing solar panels, reading about a more efficient solution in the news. - Network issue or new requirement arises - New employee onboarding - System / Access requirement - Upgrade or change in infrastructure	10. YOUR SOLUTION SL If you are working on an existing business, write down your current solution first, fill in the canvas, and check how much it fits reality. If you are working on a new business proposition, then keep it blank until you fill in the canvas and come up with a solution that fits within customer limitations, solves a problem and matches customer behaviour. - Service Catalog form for request submission - Automatic creation of network request record - Automated routing for manager approval - Email notifications for approval / rejection - Real-time status tracking for users - Audit trail, reports and history in ServiceNow	8. CHANNELS OF BEHAVIOUR CH 8.1 ONLINE What kind of actions do customers take online? - ServiceNow Portal (Service Catalog) - Email Notifications - Desktop / Mobile Browser - Internal Chat / Collaboration Tools 8.2 OFFLINE What kind of actions do customers take offline? - Face-to-face requests - Phone calls - Paper forms / Notes - In-person follow-ups	Extract online & offline CH of BE	
4. EMOTIONS: BEFORE / AFTER EM How do customers feel when they face a problem or a job and afterwards? i.e. lost, insecure > confident, in control – use it in your communication strategy & design. Before: Frustrated, uncertain, time-consuming, worried After: Confident, satisfied, informed, in control, relieved				

References:

- <https://www.ideahackers.network/problem-solution-fit-canvas/>
- <https://medium.com/@epicantus/problem-solution-fit-canvas-aa3dd59cb4fe>